



PTI

Indian contingent



Women

Mirabai Chanu (49kg),
Gyaneshwari Yadav (53kg),
Seram Nirupama Devi (61kg),
Harjinder Kaur (69kg)

TOTAL MEDALS AT STAKE

48

WEIGHTLIFTING

MIRABAI CHANU

For all that Mirabai Chanu has achieved in weightlifting, she still doesn't have an Asian Games medal.

Chanu finished ninth on her Asian Games debut in 2014 and missed the 2018 edition with a back injury. At Hangzhou in 2023, she came up just short of the podium, finishing fourth in the 49kg category after suffering an injury during her warm-up. Her desperation for an Asian Games medal was evident in how, despite the injury, she twice attempted a 117kg clean and jerk. She failed both attempts and was eventually carried off the platform.

She arrives in Japan having won her third successive Commonwealth Games gold in Glasgow, although her 190kg total there was well below her personal best of 205kg. Chanu has acknowledged that the Commonwealth competition was not particularly demanding. The Asian Games, she says, will be the real test, with the strongest 49kg lifters coming from Asia.

Despite China and North Korea in the mix, Chanu's biggest challenge for a podium finish could come from Surodchana Khambao of Thailand, who edged her out by just 1kg to take bronze at the Paris Olympics.